



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*taṃ dr̥ṣṭvā vikṛtaṃ brahmā kapālakarabhūṣaṇam |
jñātvā yogena mahatā tuṣṭāva bhuvaneśvaram || 2 ||
tasya tuṣṭastadā devo varado 'smītyabhāṣata |
vṛṇīṣva varamavyagro yaste manasi vartate || 3 ||
icchāmi devadeveśa tvayā cihnamidaṃ kṛtam |
yena cihnena loko 'yaṃ cihnitaḥ syājjagatpate || 4 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 7, Verses 2-4

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Beholding the Lord Shiva in his formidable form, adorned with a skull garland, Brahma, through his profound yogic insight, recognized the Supreme Lord of the Universe. Overwhelmed with devotion, he offered heartfelt praises. Pleased by Brahma's unwavering faith, the divine Shiva responded, declaring his willingness to grant a boon. He encouraged Brahma to ask for whatever desire resided within his heart, free from doubt or hesitation. Brahma, the creator, then humbly requested that the unique symbol Shiva bore – the skull garland itself – become a recognizable mark. He asked that this symbol would serve to identify Shiva, allowing all beings in the world to recognize and connect with the divine power he embodies.

This passage speaks to the power of recognition, both of the divine and within ourselves. Brahma, representing intellect and creation, needed to *see* the truth of Shiva's supreme being. We too often need external signs, symbols, or experiences to awaken our inner awareness of the divine presence that permeates everything. The skull garland, a stark reminder of mortality, is paradoxically a sign of liberation from the cycle of birth and death when understood with spiritual insight.

In modern life, surrounded by distractions and material pursuits, we can easily lose sight of the sacred. We might seek validation from external sources, forgetting the source of true power resides within. This story invites you to cultivate your inner vision, your "yogic insight," to recognize the divine not only in the external world but also within yourself. Just as Brahma sought a recognizable symbol of Shiva, you can find symbols, practices, or moments of stillness that help you connect with your own inner truth and the universal consciousness. By acknowledging the impermanence of life, represented by the skulls, you can release attachments and embrace a deeper sense of freedom and purpose. Shiva's willingness to grant Brahma's boon highlights the responsive nature of the divine; when you sincerely seek connection, the universe conspires to guide you.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What symbols or practices resonate deeply with your soul, reminding you of the divine presence within and around you, and how can you cultivate those connections more consciously today?